C1 Grammar

Future perfect and future continuous

Look back from a point in the future and describe actions in progress then, with precise future forms.

At C1 you need more than *will* and *going to*. The future continuous and the two future perfect forms let you place an action exactly in relation to a future moment.

Form	Use	Example
will be + -ing	An action in progress at a future time	*This time tomorrow I'll be flying to London.*
will be + -ing	A polite question about plans	*Will you be using the car tonight?*
will have + past participle	Completed before a future time	*By June, we'll have finished the project.*
will have been + -ing	Duration up to a future time	*In May, I'll have been working here for ten years.*
be due to / be about to	Scheduled or very near future	*The train is due to arrive at six. The film is about to start.*

Key time words. *By (the time), by then, by the end of* usually signal the future perfect. *This time next week, at 8 tomorrow* usually signal the future continuous.

Common mistake. After *by the time, when, before* use the present, not *will*: *By the time you arrive, I'll have left*, not *By the time you will arrive*.

Practice

1. Complete: By 2030, scientists ___ (find) a cure.
2. Complete: Don't call at nine; I ___ (have) dinner.
3. Complete: Next month she ___ (teach) for twenty years.

4. Correct the mistake: By the time he will get here, the meeting will have ended.
5. Ask politely about someone's plans: use the printer this afternoon.

Teacher page: answers

Print the pages before this one for students.

Answers

1. will have found
2. will be having
3. will have been teaching
4. By the time he gets here, the meeting will have ended.
5. Will you be using the printer this afternoon?